Writing: A day when something went wrong

Day 2 · Writing

What to do: Discuss first (exercise 1), then write in the copybook at home or in class.

Murphy today
Murphy red, Unit 11 (page 33): **11.3** at home (see the grammar file). Unit 12 (page 35): **12.1**.

1 Warm-up: talk before you write (5 minutes, in pairs)

1. Think of a day when something went wrong: a burned meal, a lost key, a broken phone. What happened?
2. Where were you? Who was with you?
3. What did you plan to do that day?
4. What was the first thing that went wrong?
5. What did you do? Did you shout, laugh or keep calm?
6. Did anybody help you?
7. How did the day end? Was the result good or bad?
8. What did you learn from that day?

Choose one topic and tell it to your partner. The partner asks one more question for each of the first 3 answers.

2 Useful words

First · Then · After that · Suddenly · In the end · Luckily · Unfortunately

Past simple for events · was / were for the scene · Unit 2 words: carefully · nervous · terrible · noise · smell · laugh · secret

3 The plan: 4 short paragraphs, 100–120 words

1 · Introduction	When and where was it? What did you plan? (was / were, past simple)
2 · Body 1	First… Then… What went wrong? Use the order words.
3 · Body 2	What did you do? What didn't you do? How did you feel?
4 · Conclusion	In the end… What did you learn?

Model and your task

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What to do: In the model: the order words and the negative sentences.

The Cake That Went Wrong

Last Sunday I wanted to bake a cake for my mother's birthday. I got up early, and I was very excited. My mother was at the market, so I had one hour.

First I mixed the flour, the eggs and the sugar. Then I put the cake in the oven. I did not look at the clock, because I was busy with the decorations. After that I smelled something terrible.

Suddenly the kitchen was full of smoke! I opened the window and turned off the oven. The cake was black. I did not shout, but I wanted to cry. Luckily my mother laughed when she came home. In the end we bought a cake in a shop. I learned one thing: look at the clock!

A Choose ONE: a day when something went wrong

Write 100–120 words. Follow the plan. Use at least 6 past simple verbs (also 2 negative sentences), 3 order words and 3 words from Unit 2.

B Or: an email to a friend about it

Write 80–100 words. *Hi ..., Sorry I didn't write earlier. Yesterday something went wrong. First ... Then ... Suddenly ... In the end ... Write soon!*

Check before you finish

4 paragraphs · past simple (regular and 3 irregular) · 2 negative sentences · order words · 3 Unit 2 words · capital letters and full stops